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The Editors-in-Chief
Knowledge-Based Systems

Re: submission of "The Model Knows the Textbook but Not Your Class: Curriculum Knowledge Graph Constraints for Slide Generation in Two Vocational-Education Courses"

Dear Editors,

I am submitting the manuscript above for consideration as a research article in *Knowledge-Based Systems*.

Where the paper sits in the journal's scope. The journal's stated topics include *knowledge presentation and engineering*, and its objectives ask for work that balances theory with practical study and develops knowledge-based models, methods and tools with applications in education. This manuscript is a knowledge-representation paper before it is a generation paper, and it makes two claims of different kinds. An *effect* claim: a graph-compiled contract improves generated decks along named dimensions. A *scope* claim: which dimensions of a syllabus can be compiled into requirements that are simultaneously generation constraints and acceptance criteria is a measurable property of the representation rather than a matter of taste—and that boundary depends jointly on the representation and on the backbone's willingness to execute a structural instruction. The second is the claim we expect to outlive the course, and it is why the generator is swapped for other models.

The knowledge-engineering claim. Course-level knowledge—the concepts a session must cover, the misconception this cohort keeps committing, what must not be introduced yet—is represented as a curriculum knowledge graph and compiled, before generation, into an executable contract that then serves as the acceptance criterion, so requirement and check are one data object and cannot drift. This differs from retrieval: a retrieved passage decides what the model *reads*, whereas a compiled contract decides what the output *owes*, and an unmet obligation is a defect by construction. Section 1.5 gives the representational argument: presence, absence and a corrective slot admit hard constraints; order is expressible in the graph but cannot be withheld by the interface.

What the evidence supports. The study is a six-condition experiment in one higher-vocational course (54 runs), with three one-factor ablations (27 runs), a length-matched placebo, a blind review by three teachers, the claim-bearing conditions replicated on two further models and on a second course in another language, and a run that holds the course fixed while changing only the endpoint, which is what places the reliability condition on the model rather than on the syllabus. The reported change is in the *reliability* of output rather than in its average quality: misconception handling reaches 1.000 ± 0.000 against 0.556 ± 0.527 for a control given the same text as flat passages. The ablation attributes each gain to a named knowledge component—removing the misconception slot alone returns that metric to 0.111, and the forbidden-term list buys 0.083 of out-of-graph control while moving nothing else. Two revision analyses bear on the mechanism: crossing structure against the misconception text gives an interaction of +0.556 (that text is worth +0.889 with the contract, +0.334 without), and a bounded repair loop takes the main grid from 6/9 to 9/9 in three calls while the weakest backbone moves only from 4/6 to 5/6. Seven measurement defects that had favoured constraint-based methods are documented with their fixes; the paper states plainly that it is a two-course case study with no learning-outcome measurement.

Reproducibility. Code, both curriculum graphs, prompts, the protocol and all raw outputs are archived in a public repository (Zenodo DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.XXXXXXX`); every table here and in the supplementary material is regenerated from it by the included scripts. No proprietary or licensed textbook content is redistributed.

Declarations. The manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has a single author responsible for all parts of the work. No competing interests; no specific grant from funding agencies in the public, commercial or not-for-profit sectors. The course data are aggregate classroom statistics; no student-level record is included.

I would be glad to provide any further information the editors require, and I thank you for considering the manuscript.

Yours sincerely,

Suxing Liu